A7

Publish with GitHub Pages + Auto Activity Log

B11309044

https://github.com/fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a7

Project overview

Repository

https://github.com/fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a7

- Public repository under fanyuzhenfu
- Initial Pages source: main / root
- README is the activity-log homepage
- Final source: GitHub Actions with gated deployment

Assignment goal

Publish a simple site, update README automatically, and prevent invalid content from reaching the live page.

GitHub Pages setup

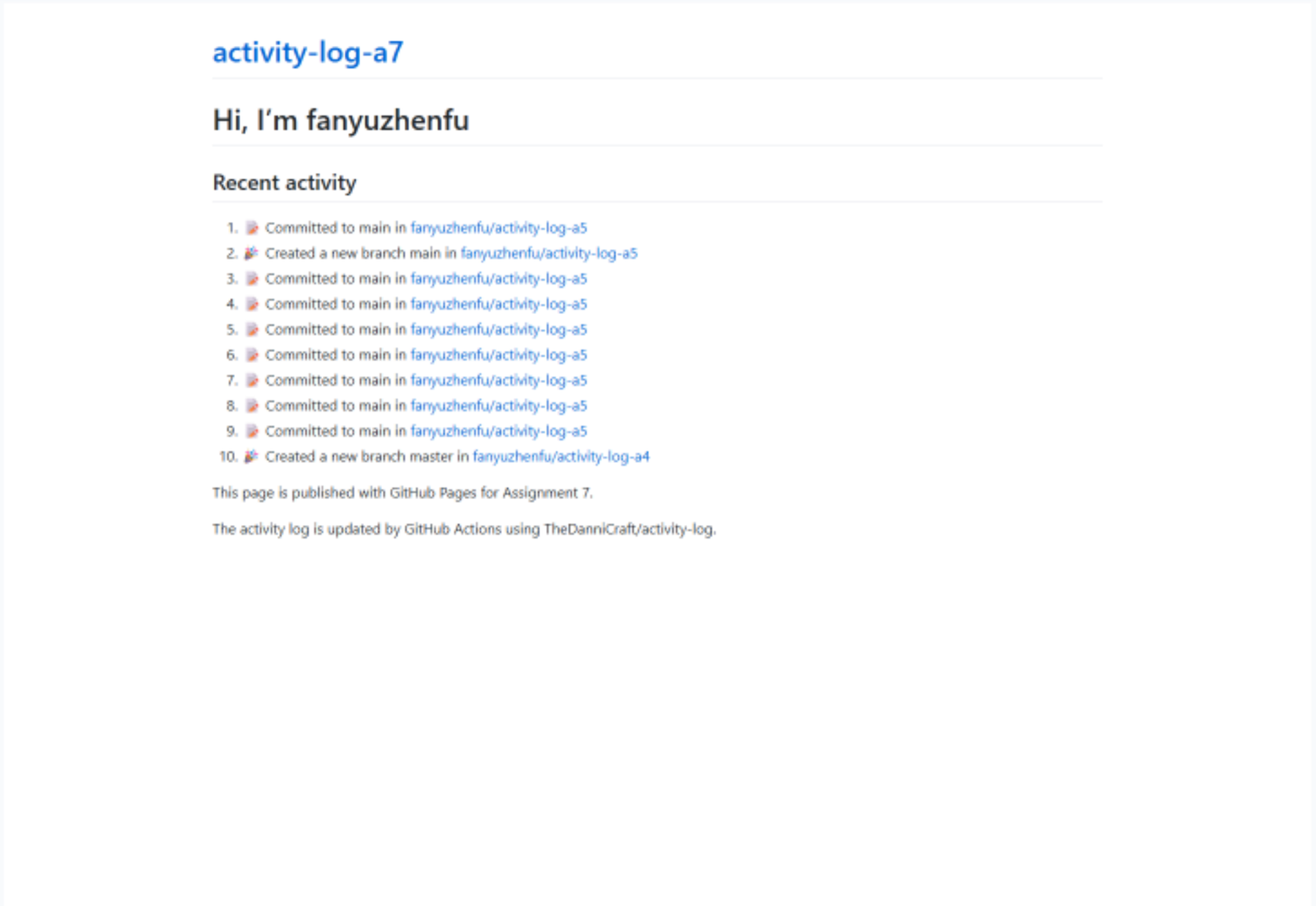
Pages source: main / root
Build type: legacy
Status: built

Pages build evidence

https://github.com/fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a7/actions/runs/41182258941

- Live URL was checked with a real HTTPS request.
- Initial branch deployment created the first public page.
- The page uses Jekyll so include_relative can render README.md.

Published website



activity-log-a7

Hi, I'm fanyuzhenfu

Recent activity

1. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
2. Created a new branch main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
3. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
4. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
5. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
6. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
7. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
8. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
9. Committed to main in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a5
10. Created a new branch master in fanyuzhenfu/activity-log-a4

This page is published with GitHub Pages for Assignment 7.

The activity log is updated by GitHub Actions using TheDanniCraft/activity-log.

Live verification

- HTTP 200 OK
- Recent activity section is visible
- README content is rendered through index.md
- https://fanyuzhenfu.github.io/activity-log-a7/

Automatic activity log

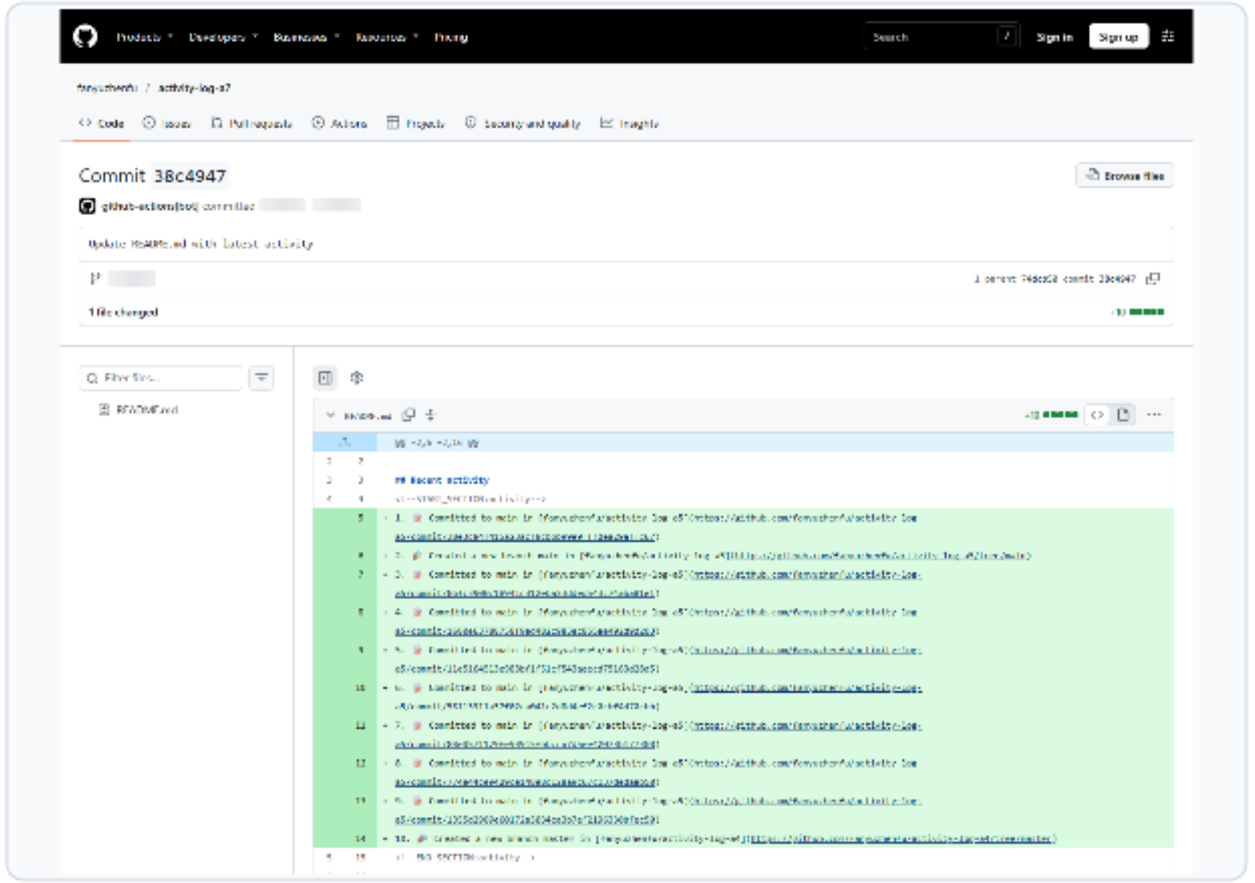

```
name: Update activity log
on:
  schedule:
    - cron: "0 */6 * * *"
  workflow_dispatch:
permissions:
  contents: read
uses: actions/checkout@v4
  TheDanniCraft/activity-log@v1
  GITHUB_USERNAME: fanyuzhenfu
  GITHUB_TOKEN: ${{ secrets.TOKEN }}

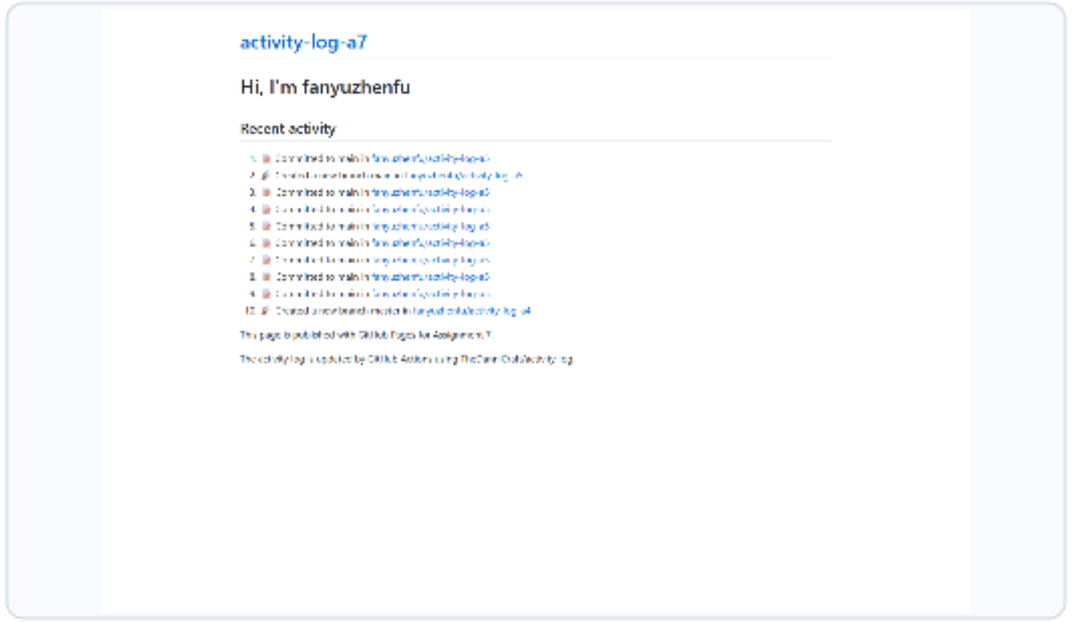
README markers:
<!--START_SECTION:activity-->
<!--END_SECTION:activity-->
```

Secret safety

- TOKEN exists as a repository secret.
- The token value never appears in code or logs.
- The schedule was enabled only after the secret was configured.

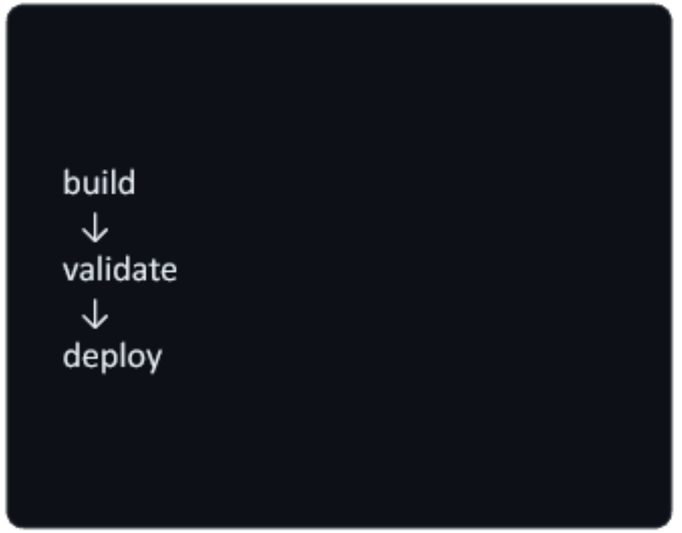
Activity update to Pages





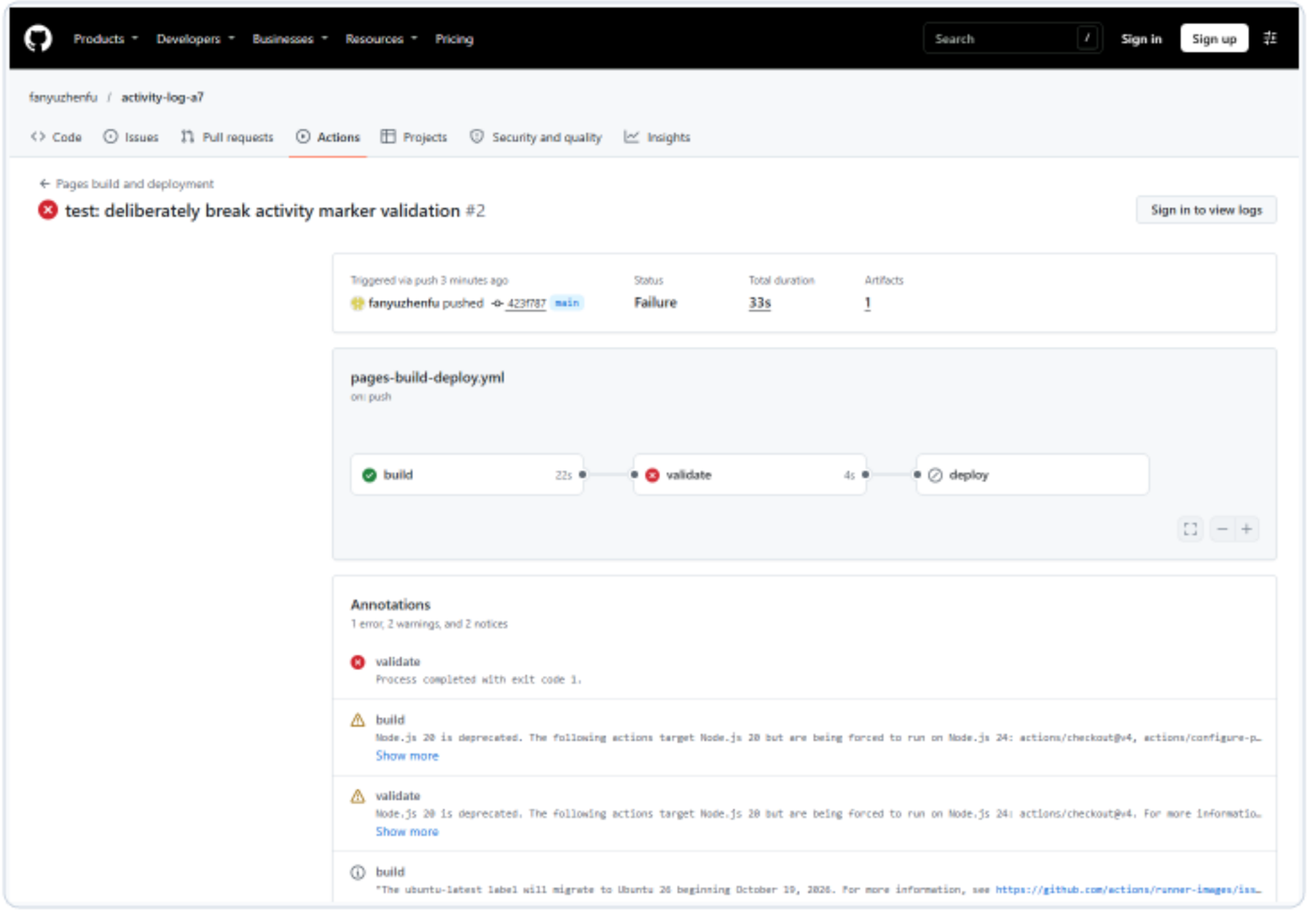
Run 41183083659 Commit 38c4947 Pages build 1329285214 **Live HTTP 200**

Gated deployment design



- Build uses actions/jekyll-build-pages.
- Validate checks README markers and index.md.
- Deploy needs validate, so failure stops publication.
- The workflow does not modify README, avoiding loops.

Deliberate failure test

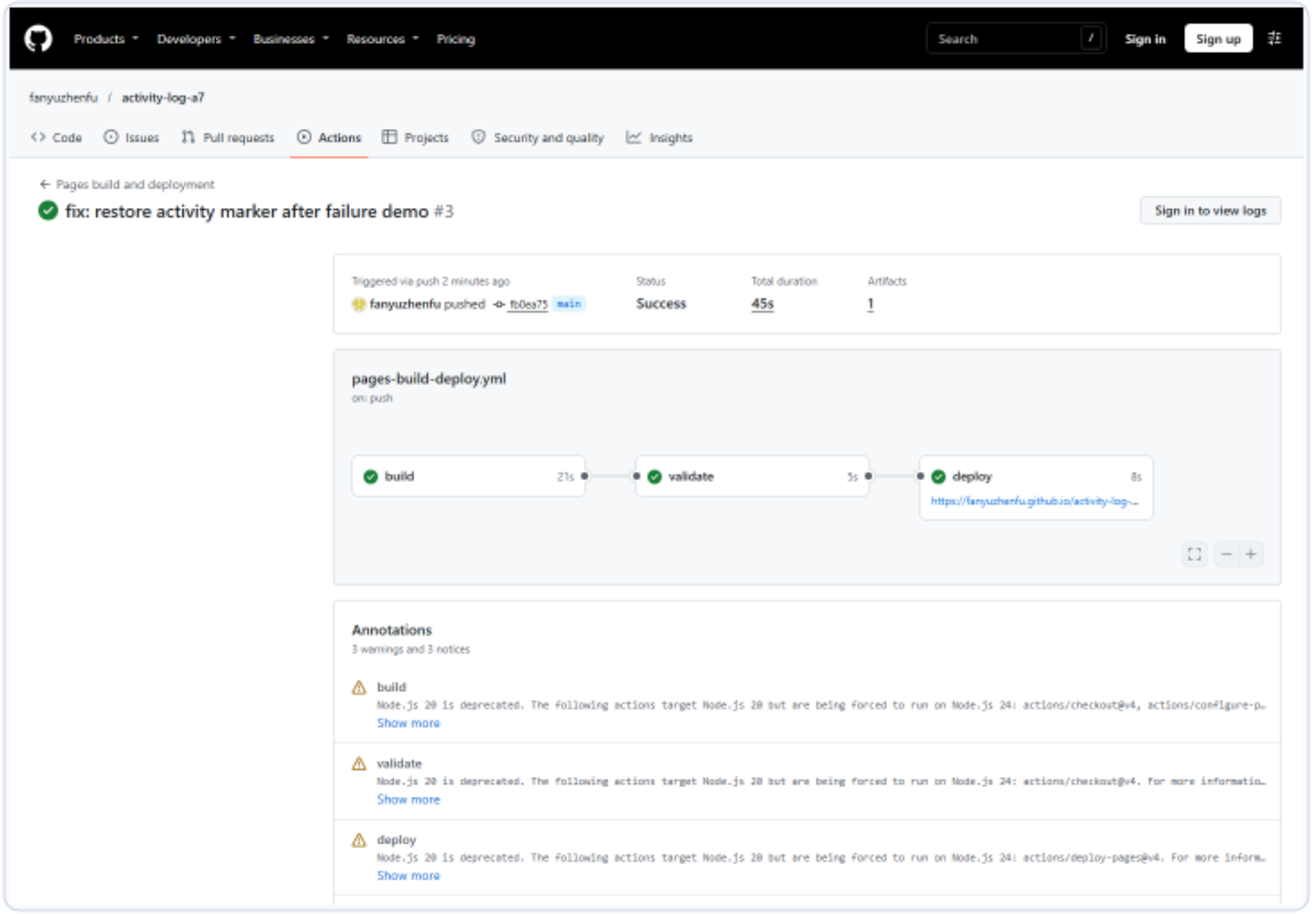


Run 41183626360

- Build succeeded.
- Validate failed because the end activity marker was changed.
- Deploy was skipped.
- The old live site still returned HTTP 200.

Failure commit: 423f787

Recovery and release safety



Run 41183714027

Why

Gated deploy prevents invalid content from reaching the live site.

Result

After restoring the marker, all three jobs passed and deployment completed.

Limitation

Validation checks the markers and entry file. It is not a full HTML or link checker.

Node.js and ubuntu-latest warnings were recorded but did not block the run.

Reflection

This was my first time using GitHub Pages, an activity log action, and an automated deployment workflow. At first, I thought publishing a simple page would be easy, but I needed to understand how README, Jekyll, and Pages work together.

I also had to solve a real problem when the site first returned 404. The Pages build had already succeeded, but the website still needed some time before it became available. Later, I intentionally changed the activity marker and saw the Validate job fail while Deploy was skipped.

This helped me understand why a gated deployment is useful. I am still learning CI/CD, but I now know how to check workflow logs and verify the final website instead of assuming that a successful commit means the site is ready.